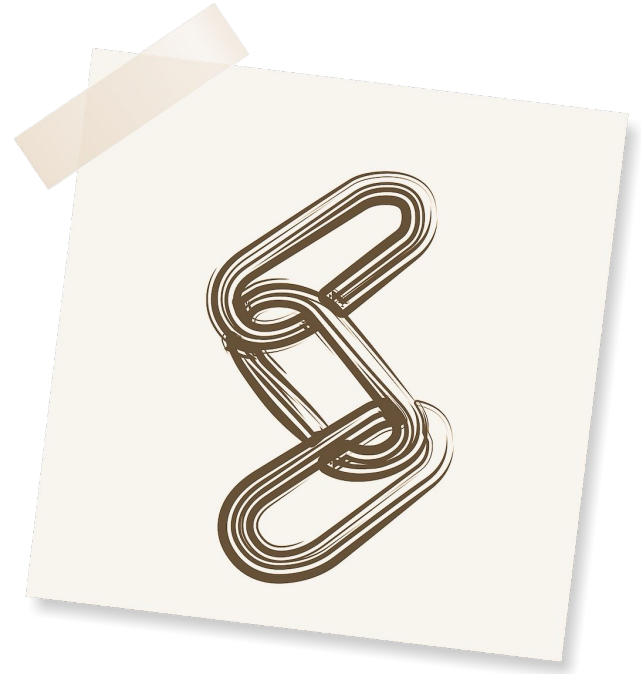


Lesson 7: Annotated bibliography

HS192 Introduction to Writing - 2
@ IITGN, 2025-26



Today's learning objective

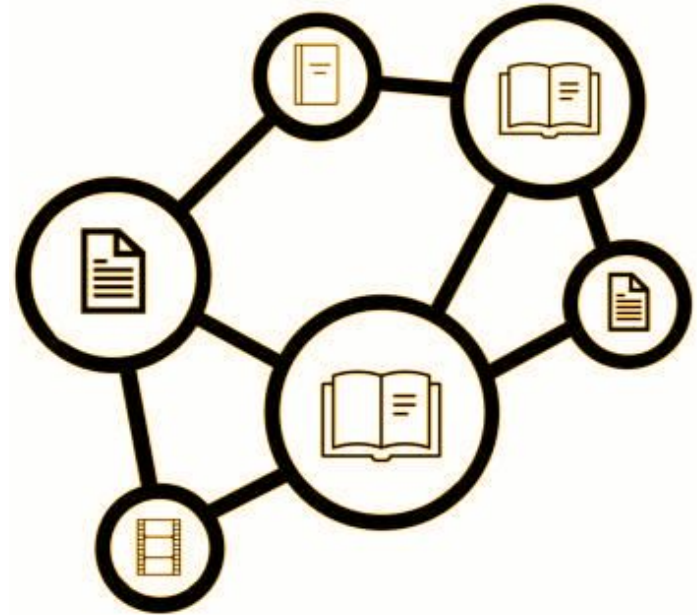
**Analyze and synthesize
research for an academic paper**

What is an annotated bibliography?

It is a list that collects, summarizes, and analyzes key sources about your topic.

Keeping it is useful in the research process:

- To understand your topic
- To narrow your focus
- To develop your thesis



Typical entry of an annotated bibliography

For each source has a proper citation, summary, and evaluation

- Citation: Use a relevant reference style
- Part 1
 - Summarize: What is the main idea? What methods/designs were used? What evidence was used? What is the purpose of the paper?
- Part 2
 - Analyze: Is the source credible? Is the argument solid? What are the strengths and weaknesses?
 - Appraise: Is it useful for my research? How relevant is it?

H. Brink-Roby, "Siren canora: The mermaid and the mythical in late nineteenth-century science", *Arch. of Natural Hist.*, vol. 35, no. 1, pp.1-14, Apr. 2009 [Online]. Available: <https://doi:10.3366/E0260954108000041>

This article talks about how mythical creatures fit into the discussion of evolution. The author views the mermaid as the battleground for conflicting responses to Darwin's evolutionary theories in the mid-late 19th century. Some scholars considering Darwin's work thought the mermaid was biologically possible because of the extensive biodiversity already recognized at the time, yet Darwin's ideological opponents saw representations of mythological creatures as clear evidence of the absurdity of his claims concerning adaptation and evolution.

This article seems credible because (i) the author examined primary sources dating 1850-1900 rather than contemporary secondary sources about the 19th century's scientific culture and (ii) I can see her efforts to include research from both sides of the debate surrounding Darwin's theory. In addition, her essay was published in a peer-reviewed publication and selected as the 2007 winner of the William T. Stearns Student Essay Prize from the Society for the History of Natural History. I can use this article to demonstrate the fluidity of scientific thought and how new evidence contributes to conversations in natural history. The source demonstrates that while reactions to Darwin based on mythological creatures may seem comical today, such interpretations represented serious scientific thought in the late 19th century.

How did the summary and evaluation go?

What is the source about? What are its main points?

What is the assessment of the source?

How useful is an annotated bibliography?

It is a formal version your reading note, which helps your memory and reusing information for your future use.

In next class, we will conduct group activities on searching sources, evaluating, and compiling relevant information.

How to make an annotated bibliography

Roughly how many sources should you include?

What types of sources (books, journal articles, websites)?

How should I organize it?

(Do NOT include irrelevant sources!)

Typical format of annotated bibliography

Centered title

A half-inch hanging indent for second and subsequent lines of the citation

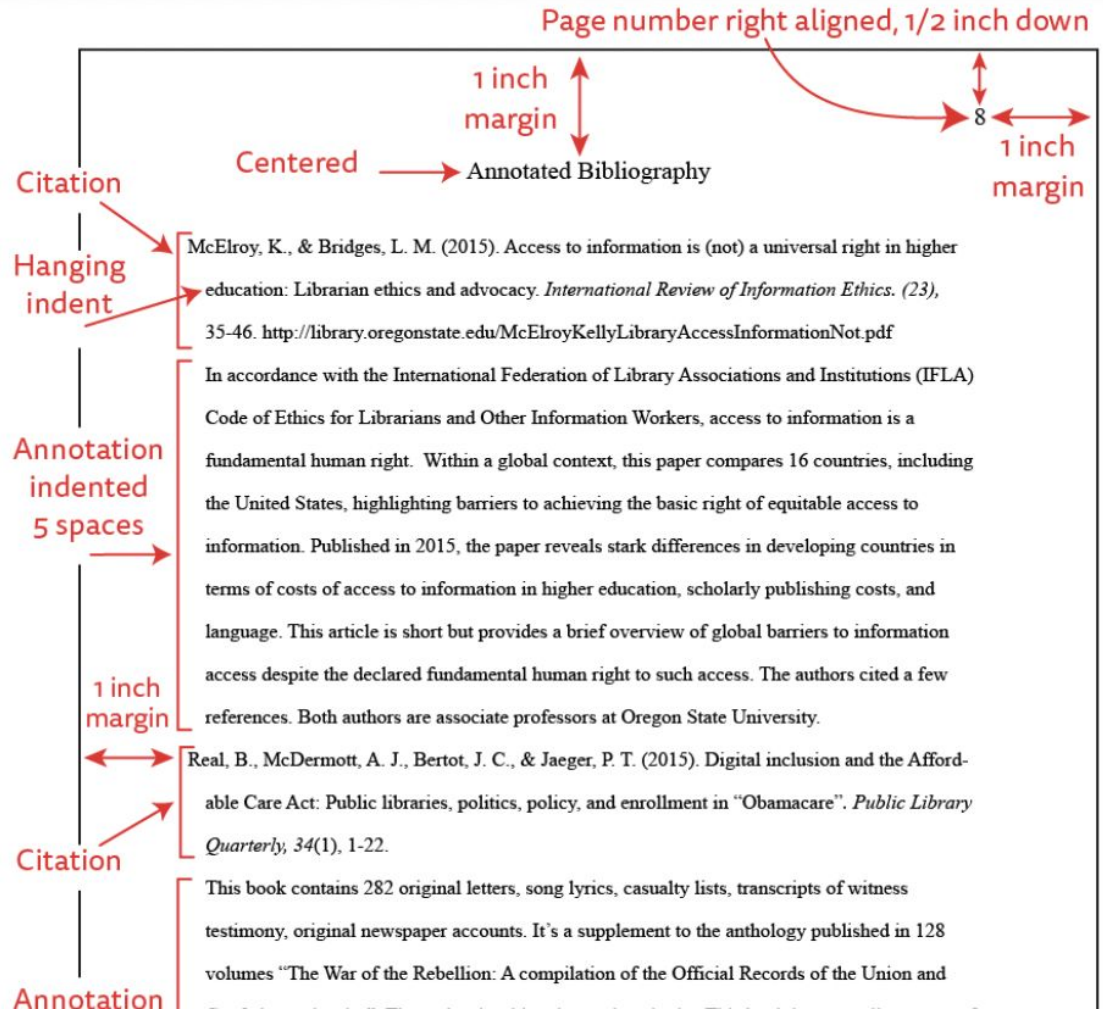
Do not “cut and paste” from the original source; if you’d like to use a phrase or a sentence directly from it, use double-quotation marks

Centered → Annotated Bibliography

Austen, J. (2008). *Pride and Prejudice*. Ignatius Press.

In *Pride and Prejudice*, the author Jane Austen examines the class differences found in society, along with the disparage between men and women. She uses rhetorical devices and humor to cover up the....

Sample format: APA annotated bibliography



Group activity

Read the annotated bibliography entries [here](#).

Work as a group. For each entry:

1. Write one sentence summarizing what the article is about, based on the annotations.
2. Then, write one sentence that explains how each source will help the writer.
3. Finally, come up with 1-2 suggestions to make these annotations better.



Debrief

What is the article about, based on the annotation or annotations?

How will each source help the writer?

What are your suggestions about to make such annotations better?

Today's learning objective -2

**Analyze and synthesize
research for an academic
paper.**

What is synthesis?

In writing, synthesis means combining multiple sources. Synthesis can be used for:

- A theoretical review report examining theories on a topic
- An argumentative essay comparing differing views and supporting a coherent claim
- A business report examining different ideas and blending them into a suggestion



Two types of synthesis in academic writing

Explanatory syntheses seek to bring sources together to explain a perspective and the reasoning behind it.

Argumentative syntheses seek to bring sources together to make an argument.

Both types of synthesis involve looking for relationships between sources and drawing conclusions.

Does a synthesis sound different from a summary? Why or why not?

A summary restates the information in one or more sources without providing new insight or reaching new conclusions.

A synthesis draws on multiple sources to reach a broader conclusion.

Process of search and synthesis

1. Ensure the sources are credible and relevant to your broad topic
2. Look for connections among the sources
 - a. First, check what individual sources are saying.
 - b. Can they be grouped by specific topic or point? Any patterns or specific topic similarities?
3. What kind of story can you make out of their comparison and/or contrast?

- Don't force a relationship between sources if there isn't one. Not all of your sources have to complement one another.
- Do your best to highlight the relationships between sources in very clear ways.

Is it an effective synthesis?

Franz (2008) studied undergraduate online students. He looked at 17 females and 18 males and found that none of them liked the APA style guidelines. According to Franz, the evidence suggested that all students are reluctant to learn citations style. Perez (2010) also studied undergraduate students. She looked at 42 females and 50 males and found that males were significantly more inclined to use citation software ($p < .05$). Findings suggest that females might graduate sooner. Goldstein (2012) looked at British undergraduates. Among a sample of 50, all females, all were confident in their abilities to cite and were eager to write their dissertations.

A stronger synthesis

Studies of undergraduate students reveal conflicting conclusions regarding relationships between advanced scholarly study and citation efficacy. Although Franz (2008) found that no participants enjoyed learning citation style, Goldstein (2012) determined in a larger study that all participants felt comfortable citing sources, suggesting that variables among participant and control group populations must be examined more closely. Although Perez (2010) expanded on Franz's original study with a larger, more diverse sample, the findings were similar.

Source: [The Chicago School](https://www.simplypsychology.org/synthesising.html), via <https://www.simplypsychology.org/synthesising.html>,

Group activity

In this activity, you will write your own synthesis for several sources in an annotated bibliography.

Read the annotated bibliography [here](#).

As a group, write a paragraph that synthesizes the sources. Remember, you aren't just summarizing, you are finding similarities and differences and coming to a larger conclusion.



Debrief

What challenges did you encounter in synthesizing your sources?

What method(s) was the most successful?